

Portugal

Sovereign government data centre network — capacity, legal posture, provider landscape and migration path.

1 Starting point

Population	11.39 m
GDP	EUR 307 bn
Public administration (NACE O)	342 k
Electricity price	132.9 EUR/MWh
Renewables	65.8%
Live hyperscaler regions	0

2 What is structurally different

- Grid isolation. The national grid is an electrical island or nearly so (weak or single interconnection). The April 2025 Iberian blackout and Cyprus/Malta interconnector outages show the failure mode. Every site needs on-site generation and storage sized for multi-day ride-through, and the PUE and facility CAPEX assumptions should be revisited upward once site studies exist.
- High seismic risk. Base isolation or seismic-rated structures are mandatory, not optional, at the primary site; the second and third regions should be chosen in a different seismic domain so a single event cannot take out two regions. Expect facility CAPEX above the EUR 10 m/MW planning figure.
- No hyperscaler region in-country. Unlike the Netherlands, there is no commercial hyperscale tier to fall back on for non-critical workloads without leaving the jurisdiction. The sovereign core therefore has to be sized for a larger share of total government demand, and the hybrid model (Dutch GOAL.md section 7) needs a cross-border commercial tier.

3 Capacity

Servers	2,793 (CPU 1,964 / GPU 109 / storage 720)
IT critical load	4.4 MW
Facility design load	6.6 MW
Sites	3 (by capacity 1, floor 3)
Average per site	2.2 MW
Site count set by	the minimum-sites floor, not capacity
CAPEX	EUR 155 m
OPEX	EUR 13 m / yr

4 Proposed geography

Region	Role	Share	MW	Notes
Lisbon	Primary civil cloud	41%	2.7	AMA/eSPap estate, GigaPIX; seismic/tsunami design mandatory.
Sines / Alentejo	Sovereign secondary	27%	1.8	Atlantic cable hub, Start Campus proves 1 GW-class grid; renewables.
Porto / North	Government / continuity	23%	1.5	300 km separation, lower seismicity, Douro hydro.
Coimbra / Centre	Strategic reserve	10%	0.7	Inland reserve between the two metros.

First-pass geographic hypotheses encoding only the obvious constraints, to be replaced by scored site selection.

5 Legal and regulatory posture

Governing instrument	Cloud policy under AMA (Administrative Modernisation Agency); iAP interoperability platform
Cloud certification	No national scheme; ISO 27001
Data classification	Lei do Segredo de Estado: Reservado / Confidencial / Secreto / Muito Secreto
Procurement route	ESPAP shared-services agency central frameworks

Foreign jurisdiction exposure. No major in-country region; Microsoft and AWS consumed from Spanish and Irish regions

Under the US CLOUD Act and FISA 702 a provider subject to US jurisdiction can face a lawful order for data it holds regardless of where that data sits. Residency is necessary but not sufficient; what matters is who holds the keys and who can be compelled.

6 Current state and provider landscape

Government cloud	Plano Nacional de Nuvem Soberana - approved May 2026 (ARTE): data classification, technical requirements, phased state sovereign-cloud infrastructure; builds on Nuvem da AP (AMA/eSPap)
Maturity	operational
Digital identity	Chave Movel Digital / Cartao de Cidadao
Interconnection	GigaPIX Lisbon; Sines landing hub (EllaLink 2Africa Equiano Medusa)

7 Migration path and cost

Phase	Scope	MW	CAPEX	Cumulative	Hybrid
1	Sovereign core	1.9	EUR 36 m	23%	no
2	Security and defense	2.5	EUR 61 m	63%	no
3	State record	1.1	EUR 28 m	81%	no
4	Elective	1.1	EUR 30 m	100%	no

Phase 1 is the number that matters: **EUR 36 m** for 1.9 MW, 23% of total CAPEX. That is the floor below which no hybrid arrangement helps — and it is a small fraction of the full build.

8 Geography and threat notes

Seismic/tsunami exposure Lisbon-Algarve-Azores (1755 fault systems); wildfire and drought inland; Iberian grid island with weak links to France (Apr 2025 blackout) but cheap high-renewable power and land near Sines; very low geopolitical risk